8.1.3 Differences between bank column of cash book and bank statement

Following are the differences between bank column of cash book and bank statement:

S.No.	Bank column of cash book	Bank statement
1	It is prepared by business concern.	It is prepared by bank (banker).
2	Cash deposits are entered on the debit side.	Cash deposits are entered in the credit column.
3	Cash withdrawals are entered on the credit side.	Cash withdrawals are entered in the debit column.
4	Cheque deposits are debited on the day of deposit.	Cheque deposits are credited only at the time of realisation of cheque.
5	Cheques issued are credited on the day of issue of cheque.	Cheques issued by customers are debited by bank on the date on which the payment is made.
6	Collections and payments as per standing instructions of the business are entered only after checking with the bank statement.	Collections and payments as per standing instructions of the business are entered in the banker's book on the date of realisation or payment.
7	It is balanced at the end of a specific period.	It is balanced after each transaction.

8.2 Bank Reconciliation Statement

If every entry in the cash book matches with the bank statement, then bank balance will be the same in both the records. But, practically it may not be possible. When the balances do not agree with each other, the need for preparing a statement to explain the causes arises. This statement is called bank reconciliation statement (BRS). The bank reconciliation statement is a statement that reconciles the balance as per the bank column of cash book with the balance as per the bank statement by giving the reasons for such difference along with the amount. As a result of this, internal record of a business (bank column of cash) can be reconciled with external record (bank statement).

8.2.1 Need for bank reconciliation statement

It is important to compare the bank statement and bank column of cash book. If the two balances do not match, it is necessary to reconcile them to explain why the differences have occurred. It may be prepared every month, every week or even daily depending on the number of transactions and the needs of the business.



The need for bank reconciliation statement is as follows:

(i) To identify the reasons for the difference between the bank balance as per the cash book and bank balance as per bank statement.

(ii) To identify the delay in the clearance of cheques.

(iii) To ascertain the correct balance of bank column of cash book.

(iv) To discourage the accountants of the business as well as bank from misusing funds.

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